

## Key components of India Stack beyond UPI

While UPI, Aadhaar, and e-KYC form the backbone of India Stack, other critical layers power its inclusive vision:

### 1. Account Aggregators (AA):

A consent-driven framework enabling secure sharing of financial data (bank statements, tax records, etc.) between institutions. For instance, instead of submitting physical documents for a loan, users can digitally share verified data via AAs like Finvu or CAMSFinServ, reducing processing time from days to minutes.

### 2. Open Credit Enablement Network (OCEN):

A protocol democratising credit access by connecting lenders, borrowers, and platforms. Startups like Setu use OCEN to offer micro-loans to small businesses via apps like WhatsApp or e-commerce platforms, bypassing traditional credit checks.

### 3. FASTag (NPCI):

Part of the National Electronic Toll Collection system, FASTag uses RFID tech for cashless toll payments. Integrated with UPI, it's a template for automating public infrastructure payments (e.g., parking, metro).

### 4. DEPA (Data Empowerment and Protection Architecture):

A governance framework gives users control over their data. Citizens can choose who accesses their data (e.g., banks, insurers) and for how long, ensuring privacy while enabling innovation.

### 5. Aadhaar eSign:

Allows legally valid digital signatures using Aadhaar authentication, replacing wet signatures for contracts, agreements, and filings.

digital-first economy, making everything from education to healthcare more accessible.

## Startups riding the India Stack wave

The brilliance of India Stack lies in its openness. It's not just the government using this infrastructure – startups and businesses are building on top of it to create innovative solutions. Let's look at a few examples:

### Google Pay & PhonePe

These apps use UPI to enable seamless payments, from your local grocery store to high-value business transactions. Their intuitive design and cashback incentives have made digital payments the default choice for millions.

### Razorpay

For businesses, Razorpay has leveraged India Stack to simplify online payments, invoicing, and vendor payouts. Whether you're a freelancer or an enterprise, receiving payments is now faster and more transparent.

### Startups using Aadhaar for financial inclusion

Fintech startups like Lendbox and ZestMoney use Aadhaar-based e-KYC to provide instant credit lines to users with minimal documentation. This is especially impactful for those with limited credit histories, bringing financial access to the underserved.

## Future of India Stack

While India Stack has already made

life easier in countless ways, the future promises even more seamless integration across industries. Here's what's next:

### UPI for global transactions

The National Payments Corporation of India (NPCI) is working to take UPI beyond Indian borders. Partnerships are already in place in UAE, Singapore, and Europe, allowing Indian travellers and NRIs to use UPI for international transactions. As more countries integrate this system, UPI could become a global standard for digital payments.

### Digital health records

With the Ayushman Bharat Digital Mission, India is creating a unified digital health ID for citizens. This means your medical history, prescriptions, and past treatments will be securely stored and easily accessible across hospitals and healthcare providers. Patients will no longer need to carry physical reports, making healthcare more efficient and patient-friendly.

### e-Signature adoption

Businesses are increasingly adopting Aadhaar-based digital signatures, eliminating the need for physical paperwork. This shift will streamline bureaucratic processes and reduce fraud.

## A frictionless digital economy?

India Stack is more than just technology; it's an equaliser. It has bridged the gap between urban and rural, rich and poor, tech-savvy and first-time digital users.

Today, a farmer in a remote village and a corporate executive in Mumbai use the same payment system, access the same banking services, and benefit from the same digital infrastructure. As India moves towards a completely digital economy, the focus should be on enhancing security, privacy, and innovation. The question is no longer "Will India go digital?" – we already have. The next question is: How soon will the world catch up? 